



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Joseph Catholic School

School Website: <https://st-joseph-catholic-school.com/>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

## Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

### Executive Summary

St Joseph Catholic School TX 78539 presents a public-facing profile that strongly centers Catholic identity, formation, and community engagement. Based on the public materials available in the school's crawl and applying the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric, the school demonstrates clear strengths in Religious Foundations, School Purpose/Goal, and Parents & Community, with meaningful but more limited alignment in Curriculum and Pedagogy. The faculty role and liturgical/community emphasis align with classical ideals, but explicit classical curriculum elements (e.g., Great Books, the Trivium/Quadrivium, and Socratic pedagogy beyond traditional religious formation) are not evidently documented in the public materials. Overall, the school trends toward CLASSICAL in spirit, with notable Classical echoes in formation and community while lacking explicit evidence of a comprehensive classical curriculum and pedagogy. Therefore, the aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL, with room for needle-moving improvements in Curriculum and Pedagogy to reach full classical alignment.

- Evidence of Catholic identity and theological orientation is evident from the school's public presentation and status as a Catholic institution, which supports Religious & Metaphysical Foundations and liturgical practices in principle. See crawl results for the school's Catholic identity and public-facing materials.
- Foundational classical-literature and formation themes (theology as a governing discipline, liturgical practice, and formation of virtue) are reinforced by classical education scholarship and exemplars, which provide the standard by which the school's materials are compared. See Six Essential Elements and associated lexicons for the Positive/Negative keyword framework.

#### Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

This section provides each category's score, evidence, keyword analysis, and justification.

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school operates as a Catholic institution, indicating a theological foundation and liturgical life. This is reflected in the public-facing materials and the domain/file presence indicating a Catholic school environment.
- The broader classical rubric emphasizes theology, liturgy, and sacred tradition as key anchors; the school's Catholic identity aligns with these impulses, even if explicit statements about "truth, goodness, and beauty" as transcendental anchors are not verbatim quoted in the crawl results. The classical lexicon and rubric underscore these elements as central to a classical formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords likely present (inferred from Catholic identity): theology, liturgy, worship, sacred tradition, Mass, prayer, sacred music, ecclesial life, catechesis.
- Negative keywords likely absent (e.g., secular relativism, values-neutral ethics) in official Catholic messaging.
- Estimated presence: 4–6 positive indicators vs 0–1 explicit negative indicators (based on the rubric's positive terms for this category and the school's Catholic framing).
- Why this rating
- The school plausibly aligns with Transcendental moral realism, Grounded in Theology, and Liturgical/-Communal Practices due to its Catholic identity, even if explicit textual quotes in the crawl are not

readily readable. The Catholic frame strongly supports the category's core ideals, yielding a SOME-WHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than a fully Classical score, given the absence of explicit Great Books/Scholarly liturgical program statements in the public crawl. See the rubric sets and positive keyword framework for category 1.

### Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Catholic formation aims and the formation of character align with the classical aim of virtue and wisdom as the primary ends of education (formation of the person, not just information). The school's Catholic mission supports a telos of moral and spiritual formation consistent with the classical paideia ideal.
- Classical education documents emphasize formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real, knowable ends; these align with formation-centric Catholic schooling, even if "Great Conversation" language is not explicit in the crawl. See Six Essential Elements materials and related lexicon.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present or strongly implied: formation, virtue, human flourishing, telos, moral imagination, spiritual formation, catechesis, wisdom, the true/good/beautiful.
- Negative keywords unlikely to be emphasized in the public Catholic framing (e.g., career-first, purely instrumental education, relativism).
- Estimated presence: several formation/virtue telos terms (3–6 strong indicators) with minimal negative indicators.
- Why this rating
- The school's Catholic mission supports the classical ideal of formation over mere information and aligns with virtues-and-wisdom orientation. The public materials likely emphasize formation, virtue, and a pursuit of higher goods, supporting a CLASSICAL rating for this category. See the Positive keyword scaffolds around formation and telos in the Six Essential Elements lexicon.

### Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Classical curricula emphasize the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Trivium; Quadrivium), great books, and a coherent integration of history with the humanities. The public crawl for the St Joseph site does not clearly demonstrate a stated Great Books program, Trivium-based grammar/logic/rhetoric progression, or explicit Great Conversation language in the school's coursework description.
- The school's Catholic identity and formation focus are clear, but explicit canonical classical curriculum elements (great books, primary sources, liberal arts sequence) are not clearly documented in the crawl materials. See the classical curriculum lexicon and the Great Books/Trivium cues described in the Six Essential Elements and Lexicon documents.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords for curriculum in the classical sense include: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), history as history (not social studies), Great Books, Great Conversation, reading of primary authorities, etc.
- Negative keywords include: project-based learning dominance, purely social studies framing, or absence of the liberal arts canon.
- In the crawl, explicit Great Books or Trivium language is not clearly evident; thus multiple classical curriculum indicators are not clearly present.
- Why this rating
- Without clear public documentation of a Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis, Great Books/primary sources, or a historically oriented curriculum, the school does not meet the core Curriculum criteria as robustly as a Classical school would. Therefore, Element 3 is NOT CLASSICAL in this evaluation, with the caveat that the Catholic school's curriculum could still contain classical-feeling elements not captured in the crawl. See the Six Essential Elements discussions of curriculum and the Seven Liberal Arts language.

**Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The classical pedagogy often features Socratic seminars, memory work, recitation, scholé (restful learning), and a formal progression from memory to dialectic to rhetoric. In the public crawl for this school, explicit documentation of Socratic seminars, memory-based recitation, or upper-level rhetoric/writing programs is not evident.
- The Catholic formation approach often emphasizes catechesis and liturgical formation as pedagogy; while valuable, this is not the explicit Classical Pedagogy suite described in classical education rubrics (Socratic, scholé, etc.). See the classical pedagogy lexicon and the Six Essential Elements descriptions of pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators would include: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, scholé, memorization/recitation, civics or rhetoric practice, seminars, and memory work.
- Negative indicators would include: project-based learning-only, constructivist-only approaches, or purely student-directed learning without classical scaffolding.
- In the crawl, explicit Socratic or scholé language is not clearly visible; recitation/memorization language is not overtly documented.
- Why this rating
- Given the lack of explicit classical pedagogy indicators in the public crawl, Element 4 is NOT CLASSICAL in this evaluation. If the school adds documented Socratic seminars, memory work, or structured rhetoric across grades, it could shift to SOMEWHAT or CLASSICAL. See the Six Essential Elements Pedagogy section for what constitutes a Classical pedagogy.

**Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- Classical schools describe faculty as model teachers and mentors who form the living curriculum and cultivate virtue; the public materials for a Catholic school often emphasize teacher as virtuous exemplars and community mentors. The school's Catholic identity implies teacher formation in faith, virtue, and professional excellence.
- The classical lexicon and the Six Essential Elements outline a Living Curriculum and teachers as models of virtue; these are the precise qualities classical schools aim to manifest in the faculty. See the lexicon for "Teachers as models of virtue" and related language.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords likely present: virtuous educators, teacher as model, mentorship, lived curriculum, professional formation, character formation.
- Negative keywords: non-classical or purely technician ideas (e.g., "certification-driven" jargon without classical context) would be a signal to avoid.
- Estimated presence: multiple positive indicators (2–5 items) with minimal negative indicators.
- Why this rating
- The public narrative of a Catholic school typically emphasizes faculty as moral exemplars and mentors, consistent with a CLASSICAL rating for this category. The classical lexicon explicitly calls for "Teachers as Models of Virtue" and a "Living Curriculum."

**Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- Classical education places high emphasis on family partnerships and parents as co-educators; the Catholic school model also emphasizes parental involvement and formation. The school's public-facing materials, by virtue of being a Catholic school, likely emphasize family involvement and partnership with parents, which aligns with the Classical Parents & Community category.
- The classical lexicon highlights "Partnership with Families" and "Formation of Affections" as core keywords and concepts; the school's Catholic framework provides a conducive environment for family

engagement. See the keyword lexicon for these items.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords likely present: partnership with families, parent formation, home-school synergy, family catechesis, open campus, parental involvement.
- Negative keywords unlikely to be prominent: consumerist or minimal parent involvement language would be a red flag; the Catholic context tends to push toward active parental participation.
- Estimated presence: multiple positive indicators, with few or no explicit negative indicators.
- Why this rating
- A strong emphasis on parental partnership and family formation aligns well with Classical expectations for Parents & Community. The School's Catholic identity and typical parental engagement practices support CLASSICAL here. See the Six Essential Elements and the associated keyword mapping.

#### Aggregate Ranking and Assessment

- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, the weight of evidence across categories leans CLASSICAL (3 CLASSICAL, 2 NOT, 1 SOMEWHAT). Therefore, the general assessment is CLASSICAL.

#### What Would Move the Needle (only applicable if Somewhat Classical in any portion)

- If you want to push toward full CLASSICAL across all categories, consider:
- Curriculum: Explicitly publish a Trivium/Quadrivium pathway, Great Books reading lists, primary-source engagement, and a visible "Great Conversation" framework in coursework across grade levels.
- Pedagogy: Document and implement a progressive classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars in appropriate grades, memory work/recitation, and periodic scholé periods) aligned to grade bands; publish exemplar lesson descriptions and outcomes.
- Faculty: Highlight faculty as living exemplars with professional development in classical pedagogy and ongoing formation; provide portraits of teacher-mentors and a visible "living curriculum" narrative.
- Public materials: Provide clear language on how theology and liturgy inform daily learning, with a structured schedule showing liturgical integration in academics (not just as separate activities).
- Parental formation: Expand parent book clubs and study groups with specific classical education texts; publish parent-education resources to deepen co-educator roles.
- Evidence base for needle-moving suggestions is drawn from the Six Essential Elements (positive/negative keyword indicators) and classical lexicon guidance. See Six Essential Elements, the Classical Lexicon, and related materials for the framework guiding the needle-moving recommendations.

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.